

CHICAGO BEARS

INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — rookies reported to Halas Hall today; veterans follow Tuesday, July 28. Camp practices run through late August in Lake Forest.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

11–6	NFC North	Ben Johnson	Ryan Poles	33
2025 RECORD	2025 CHAMPIONS	HC · YEAR 2	GM THRU 2029	2025 TAKEAWAYS (1ST)

FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **Poles & Johnson locked in step.** GM Ryan Poles' extension aligned him with head coach Ben Johnson — both under contract through the **2029** season, giving Halas Hall its cleanest continuity window in a decade.
- ◆ **New OC, same offense.** Baltimore hired away coordinator Declan Doyle, so Johnson promoted passing game coordinator **Press Taylor** (Jaguars OC, 2022–24) from within. Johnson still calls the plays, so the scheme doesn't change. Dennis Allen returns as DC and defensive play-caller; Richard Hightower stays on special teams.
- ◆ **Stadium file still open.** President/CEO Kevin Warren reiterated the Arlington Heights project — pitched as zero state construction dollars — while the club keeps doing due diligence on a Hammond, Ind. site, where enabling legislation has already passed. Springfield has signaled the project isn't a 2026 priority.
- ◆ **Caleb extension groundwork.** Poles can't formally negotiate with Williams until after year three, but the Bears have set the table for a long-term deal next offseason. The green light is Williams' to earn in 2026.

TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **TRADE** **DJ Moore to Buffalo.** Moore plus a 2026 fifth-rounder shipped to the Bills for a **2026 second-round pick**. Widely graded a win-win: Buffalo gets Josh Allen a proven separator, Chicago banks a top-64 asset and clears the WR room for its young pass catchers.
- ◆ **TRADE** **Garrett Bradbury from New England** for a 2027 fifth-rounder — the answer at center after Drew Dalman's abrupt retirement this offseason.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **Devin Bush, LB** — three years, \$30M. The tone-setter in a faster, more aggressive front seven.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **Coby Bryant, S** — three years, fresh off Seattle's Super Bowl LX run (15 starts, career-high 4 INTs in 2025).
- ◆ **SIGNED** **Neville Gallimore, DT** (2 yr / \$12M), **Cam Lewis, CB** (2 yr), **Kalif Raymond, WR** (Johnson/Randle El reunion), **Braxton Jones, LT** back on a 1-year deal worth up to \$10M.
- ◆ **RE-SIGNED** **DL Daniel Hardy** (2 yr), **LB D'Marco Jackson** (2 yr), **QB Case Keenum** (2 yr), **DB Elijah Hicks** (1 yr), **OL Jordan McFadden** (1 yr).
- ◆ **CAP** Cole Kmet and Jonah Jackson contracts reworked for space; Kmet now a lock on the 53 with Moore's targets up for grabs.

RUMOR MILL

- ◆ **SPECULATION** **Trade-deadline swing at edge rusher** is the most persistent national projection — the 2025 defense led the NFL in takeaways but ranked poorly rushing the passer and stopping the run.
- ◆ **SPECULATION** ESPN's Benjamin Solak floated a blockbuster for Colts RB **Jonathan Taylor** in his season-prediction slate. Analyst forecast, not a reported conversation.
- ◆ **SPECULATION** **Kyler Gordon's** standing is the quiet camp storyline — five games played in 2025 and a soft-tissue cascade have him fighting for his place in Year 2 of a 3-year, \$40M deal.

WHAT'S NEXT

Sat, Jul 25	Rookies & quarterbacks report to Halas Hall
Tue, Jul 28	Veterans report — full squad assembled
Jul 29 – Aug 27	Training camp practices, Lake Forest
Preseason 1	vs. Cleveland Browns (home)
Preseason 2	at Cincinnati Bengals
Preseason 3	at Tennessee Titans
Week 1	at Carolina Panthers — season opener on the road

PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **Caleb Williams, QB.** Year 3 after a genuine leap: 3,942 yards, 27 TD, 7 INT, 90.1 rating. Johnson has publicly set a higher completion-percentage bar and praised his offseason work; Williams has also been vocal about wanting grass playing surfaces.
- ◆ **Rome Odunze, WR.** The stress fracture in his left foot healed **without surgery**. With Moore gone he's the presumptive WR1 — but Luther Burden III is chasing that title.
- ◆ **Colston Loveland, TE.** Finished ninth among TEs at 713 yards in a limited rookie role; projection models have him leading Chicago in receiving with 1,000-yard upside.
- ◆ **Ozzy Trapilo, OT.** Patellar tendon injury in the Wild Card round — expected to open the season on PUP, freeing a roster spot.
- ◆ **Left tackle battle.** Braxton Jones took every first-team spring rep (44 career starts, healthy) and leads Jedrick Wills Jr. and Theo Benedet for Week 1.
- ◆ **Jaylon Johnson, CB.** Make-or-break year: missed 10 games in 2025, and his 4-yr/\$76M deal has no guarantees left after this season with an out following 2026.
- ◆ **Dillon Thieneman, S.** No. 25 overall (Oregon), 4.35 forty, ranked the draft's 11th-best pick by ESPN's Matt Miller. Starts opposite Bryant in an all-new safety tandem.
- ◆ **Kyle Monangai, RB & Austin Booker, EDGE** headline a rising sophomore class expected to absorb real snaps.

LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Sam Roush, TE	4-year deal — last unsigned 2026 draft pick, in before camp
▲ Thieneman & L. Jones	1st-rounder and OL Logan Jones signed rookie deals
▲ Miller, Hudson, WR	Scotty Miller and Kyron Hudson added to camp roster
▲ Rhattigan, Matthews III	Linebacker depth signings
▲ Ahmed, A. Johnson Jr.	RB Salvon Ahmed; ex-Packers DB Anthony Johnson Jr.
▼ Tory Taylor, P	Placed on international player exemption — doesn't count vs. 90
▼ Deion Hankins, RB	Waived
▼ Olamide Zaccheaus, WR	Departed to Atlanta in free agency
▼ Drew Dalman, C	Abrupt retirement — replaced by Bradbury

THE BOTTOM LINE

Chicago spent a cap-constrained offseason raising the floor rather than swinging big: mid-tier defensive money, a traded-for center, and a first-round safety. The offense is now unmistakably **Ben Johnson's**, built around Williams, Loveland, Odunze and Burden instead of a veteran WR1. The season hinges on whether a rebuilt secondary and a faster front seven can pair last year's league-best takeaway rate with an actual pass rush — and whether Williams' Year 3 earns the extension Poles already has drafted.